

Good Morning, Sun Country

By WILLIAM I. LATHAM

THOUGHTS WHILE STROLLING

Following a trip out of town I usually have a column or two in mind. This time, coming back from Annapolis and Washington, I had several.

So it takes a few days before I catch up on my mail and start checking El Paso over again.



Tuesday noon I took my first 30-minute stroll around the Downtown section. I must say that the thing that impressed me most was the lack of activity at the new bus terminal and the Civic Center. For months all of us have watched the construction going on at these places and now, all of a sudden, everything is halted. I hope that wage dispute is settled shortly and work resumed.

The Civic Center, and the conventions it will bring, will be a boon to all of El Paso. The sooner we get started the better.

ON INDIAN DANCING

At a recent political rally in Ysleta, in front of the Old Mission, some of the spectators were disappointed when the Tiguas did not dance. It had been announced they would do so.

Alton Griffin, commissioner for the Tigua Nation, called to explain why the Indians did not dance.

"There were two reasons," he said. "First, the rally was held in front of the church and the area from the front door, out about 100 feet, is an old Indian burial ground. The Indians will not dance in that area.

"Second, while the Indians have danced for President Johnson and do dance on days that honor their patron saints, they always vote on whether to dance or not. They had not voted on this and, for the first reason, would probably have turned down the invitation."

The Indians are Catholics and regard the church as "their" church and the space in front of the church as the "plaza of their pueblo." I think all of us should respect them for their ideas.

Incidentally, a dance team is being formed of Younger Tiguas, who will be available for local events. They will dance the "folk" dances, not the traditional dances performed on saints days or for visiting dignitaries.

Alton, it is impossible to find a telephone number for the tribe under "Tigua" or "Indian" and few people know to look under "Texas State Government, Commission for Indian Affairs." Why don't you make it easy for the Tiguas to get

phone calls from local folks seeking information about them with an easy-to-find listing?

ANNIVERSARY GIFT

Have you ever thought about a proper anniversary gift for your wife when it's your 26th or 31st or 38th wedding anniversary?

Jack Resen, promotional director of Bassett Center, and his wife, Mary Ellen, have come up with something new.

Let Jack explain:

"Mary Ellen and I decided to give each other a tree for our anniversary (27th) and to have it planted somewhere in the City, perhaps the Chamizal area. We contacted Andy Cohen, president of Beautify El Paso Association and Mrs. M. H. Welch, former president, because we wanted to work through that organization. We intend to do this every year from now on and just wish we had started many years ago. We feel that, in this way, we can do something for each other and also for El Paso."

I think it's a splendid idea and hope others adopt it.

TODAY'S LAUGH

This came from C. W. 'Spider' Webb, 200 Fourth, Tularosa, N.M.:

EVERYBODY'S BUSY

The wealthy tourist lost his pedigreed dog while stopping in a small town. He inserted an ad in the weekly paper offering a \$100 reward.

The next day, he called at the newspaper office to inquire, but found no one there but a decrepit janitor.

"Where's the newspaper force?" he asked impatiently.

"They're all out," the old man replied, "trying to find that dog of yours."

NEWSPAPERMEN IN HEAVEN?

I hadn't given any thought to whether or not there would be newspaper men in heaven until Phil Holmsberg, 808 Cincinnati, sent me a copy of the News Letter of St. Paul's Lutheran Church of El Paso. Included was this article, marked by Phil:

Men of what profession are sure to be in heaven? Newspapermen, that's who, said Charles C. Clayton, Southern Illinois University professor of journalism.

"They won't need doctors in heaven," said Professor Clayton. "Nobody will ever be sick there. They won't need preachers. Everybody there will have been saved. But people in the south end of heaven will want to know what people in the north end are doing. They'll need newspapermen."

Phil added this note:

"They will report it as it is, not as they would like it to be."